

Benefits Administration Business Process

Maintaining Benefit Plans and recording Employee Enrollments

Audience: Benefits/HR administrators and authorized support teams

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Document scope

This guide describes the approved HR Agent Sidecar data model and required business process. It distinguishes current Dataverse schema from planned application, automation, and Copilot features.

All names, dates, amounts, and identifiers in examples are fictional and intended for training.

How to use this guide

Use this guide when publishing a Benefit Plan, recording an Employee election, waiver, coverage change, or end of coverage.

Item	Guidance
Intended audience	Benefits/HR administrators and authorized support teams
System of record	Microsoft Dataverse in the HR Agent Sidecar solution
Naming convention	Business names are shown first; Dataverse logical names appear in parentheses.
Required means	The value must be present before the record can be considered process-ready. Dataverse business-required fields are also enforced by the platform or application.
Status discipline	Use the documented Status Reason transitions. Do not simulate process state with notes, record names, or ad hoc fields.

Privacy and least privilege

HR records can contain personal and financial information. Only enter data needed for the approved process. Do not place medical details, payment-card data, credentials, or unrelated sensitive information in free-text fields.

Business outcome

Benefit offerings have clear effective dates and costs, while each Employee election is represented by a separate Enrollment with traceable coverage dates and status.

Separation of concerns

Entity	Represents	Must not be used for
Benefit Plan	The organization's reusable offering from a provider.	A specific Employee's election or waiver.
Benefit Enrollment	One Employee's selected Plan and coverage period.	Changing the terms of the Plan for everyone.

Process A: create or update a Benefit Plan

1. Search by Plan Code, Name, provider, and effective period to avoid duplicates.
2. Enter a stable Plan Code and clear Plan Name.

3. Enter Provider and Benefit Category.
4. Enter Employee Cost and Employer Cost using the approved contribution period (for example, monthly). Document the period in process policy; do not mix periods.
5. Enter Effective Start and optional Effective End.
6. Activate the Plan only when terms are approved and enrollment-ready.

Example: Benefit Plan

Field	Example value
Name	Contoso Choice Medical 2027
Plan Code	MED-CHOICE-2027
Provider	Contoso Health
Benefit Category	Medical
Description	PPO medical plan; costs shown per month
Employee Cost	\$185.00
Employer Cost	\$525.00
Effective Start	January 1, 2027
Effective End	December 31, 2027
Status	Active
Plan versioning rule When costs or terms change for a new plan year, create a new effective Plan rather than overwriting a historical Plan used by existing Enrollments.	

Process B: record an Employee election

1. Confirm the Employee is eligible and the election was received through the approved enrollment channel.
2. Select the Employee and active Benefit Plan.
3. Select Coverage Level.
4. Enter Elected On, Coverage Start, and optional Coverage End.
5. Enter Employee Contribution for the Enrollment when it differs or must be snapshotted from the Plan.
6. Name the record consistently, for example "Avery Chen — Contoso Choice Medical 2027 — Family".

7. Set Status Reason to Active. The approved base process does not require manager approval.

Example: active Enrollment

Field	Example value
Name	Avery Chen — Contoso Choice Medical 2027 — Family
Employee	Avery Chen
Benefit Plan	Contoso Choice Medical 2027
Coverage Level	Family
Elected On	November 14, 2026
Coverage Start	January 1, 2027
Coverage End	Blank
Employee Contribution	\$410.00 per month
Status Reason	Active

Process C: waiver

A waiver means the Employee intentionally declined the offered coverage. Record it only when the organization requires a waiver record and the evidence exists.

1. Confirm the Employee, plan/benefit context, and waiver evidence.
2. Create or update the applicable Enrollment with the election context.
3. Set Status Reason to Waived and ensure contribution is zero unless policy states otherwise.
4. Retain waiver evidence in the approved system/location; do not place sensitive evidence in free text.

Process D: end or change coverage

8. Confirm the qualifying event or plan-year transition and effective date.
9. Set Coverage End on the existing Enrollment and change Status Reason to Ended when coverage terminates.
10. For replacement coverage, create a new Enrollment linked to the new Plan/coverage level. Do not overwrite the old Enrollment.
11. Validate that coverage periods do not overlap unless policy explicitly permits overlap.

Status Reason	Meaning	Permitted next status
Active	Coverage is current or scheduled under the Enrollment.	Waived or Ended
Waived	Employee declined the applicable offering.	Terminal; create a new Enrollment for a later election
Ended	Coverage period concluded.	Terminal; create a new Enrollment for replacement coverage

Rich life-event example

Avery has Employee Only medical coverage beginning January 1. After a marriage on May 10, Avery elects Family coverage effective June 1. End the original Enrollment on May 31 and set it to Ended. Create a second Enrollment with Family coverage starting June 1. This preserves both periods and their contributions.

Enrollment	Coverage level	Start	End	Status	Contribution
Avery — Medical — Employee Only	Employee Only	Jan 1, 2027	May 31, 2027	Ended	\$185/month
Avery — Medical — Family	Family	Jun 1, 2027	Blank	Active	\$410/month

Validation and exceptions

Condition	Required action
Plan inactive or outside effective dates	Do not enroll. Select the correct effective Plan or correct approved Plan setup.
Duplicate active Enrollment	Stop and reconcile coverage periods before saving another active record.
Coverage Start before Plan Effective Start	Correct the dates or choose the proper Plan version.
Contribution differs from Plan	Confirm approved coverage-level pricing or exception; document through the governed process.
Retroactive change	Require authorized evidence and preserve old values through

Condition	Required action
	end/new Enrollment records rather than silent overwrite.